

Step 1. Clean up the repository structure (10 minutes)

Right now you have

```
instagram-reels-analysis
├── IGPrelimAnalysis.Rmd
├── README.md
├── LICENSE
└── .gitignore
```

I'd change it to something like

```
instagram-reels-analysis
├── README.md
├── LICENSE
├── .gitignore
├── analysis/
│   ├── instagram_reels_analysis.Rmd
│   └── instagram_reels_analysis.pdf
├── data/
│   └── reels_dataset.csv
├── figures/
│   ├── figure1_views_hook.png
│   ├── figure2_skiprate_hook.png
│   ├── figure3_firstframe_boxplot.png
│   ├── figure4_length_scatter.png
│   └── figure5_regression_table.png
└── tables/
    └── regression_coefficients.csv
```

You don't absolutely need folders, but it makes the repo look much more professional.

Step 2. Rename the R Markdown file

Instead of

IGPrelimAnalysis.Rmd

Rename it to

instagram_reels_analysis.Rmd

or

analysis.Rmd

"Prelim" sounds unfinished.

Step 3. Upload the dataset

This is important.

People can't reproduce your analysis without the data.

If there is anything private, remove columns like

- reel links
- account IDs

Otherwise upload

reels_dataset.csv

Step 4. Upload your figures

This is one of the biggest improvements.

Create a folder

figures

Upload things like

figure1_views.png

figure2_skiprate.png

figure3_firstframe.png

figure4_length.png

figure5_followers.png

Step 5. Upload the paper

Once you're finished editing it,

export as

instagram_reels_case_study.pdf

Put it inside

analysis/

Step 6. Rewrite your README

This is by far the most important thing.

Currently yours just says

Statistical analysis...

That's nowhere near enough.

I'd make it something like this.

Beyond Views

Statistical Analysis of Instagram Reel Retention and Audience Growth

Overview

This project analyzes 50 Instagram Reels posted on my creator account to investigate which creative decisions are associated with viewer retention and follower growth.

Using R, I collected and analyzed metrics including:

- Hook type
- First-frame composition
- Caption characteristics
- Reel length
- Skip rate
- Follower conversion

The goal was to identify which content characteristics are associated with stronger performance for creators and brands.

Research Questions

- Which hook types are associated with lower skip rates?
 - Does first-frame composition influence viewer retention?
 - Does reel length affect skip rate?
 - Which variables best predict follower growth?
-

Methods

- Exploratory Data Analysis
- Linear Regression

- Correlation Analysis
 - Data Cleaning
 - Visualization using ggplot2
-

Key Findings

- Original creative hooks and trend-based hooks produced lower skip rates.
 - Face-first opening shots outperformed product-focused openings.
 - Reel length showed only a weak relationship with skip rate.
 - The highest-viewed hooks were not necessarily the strongest predictors of follower growth.
-

Repository Structure

analysis/

data/

figures/

tables/

Tools Used

- R
 - ggplot2
 - tidyverse
 - dplyr
-

Author

Camila Modric

That immediately makes the repository look much more polished.

Step 7. Embed images inside the README

This is huge.

Don't make people download the PDF first.

Instead, after uploading the figures,

click the image

Copy its URL

then insert

Example Visualization

![Skip Rate](figures/figure3_firstframe.png)

GitHub will automatically display it.

I'd put

3–4 graphs in the README.

Step 8. Upload the regression tables

Instead of screenshots,

save them as CSV

or

Markdown tables.

Looks much cleaner.

Step 9. Commit everything

Whenever you upload,

GitHub asks for a commit message.

Use messages like

Add analysis figures

Upload final paper

Update README

Add dataset

Improve documentation

Step 10. Put it on LinkedIn

When finished,

add

Projects

Beyond Views: Statistical Analysis of Instagram Reel Performance

GitHub:

<https://github.com/yourusername/instagram-reels-analysis>

Step 11. Publish on Medium

Don't upload the paper.

Rewrite it as a story.

Medium readers don't want

Introduction

Methods

Results

Instead start with

I analyzed 50 Instagram Reels to answer a question every creator asks:

What actually causes people to keep watching?

Then introduce your graphs.

Then your conclusions.

Then link

Full analysis on GitHub.

Step 12. Pin the repository

Once it's finished,

go to your GitHub profile

→ Customize Pins

Pin this repository.

One thing I'd add that would make this stand out

Create a `requirements.md` or `packages.md` file listing the R packages you used, or include a short section in the README:

Packages Used

- tidyverse
- ggplot2

- dplyr
- readxl
- broom
- corrplot

It's a small detail, but it signals that someone cloning the project knows exactly what they need.

Before you publish

I'd use this checklist:

- ☒ Rename `IGPrelimAnalysis.Rmd`.
- ☒ Upload the cleaned dataset (`.csv`).
- ☒ Upload the final case study PDF.
- ☒ Upload all figures.
- ☒ Replace the README with a detailed project overview.
- ☒ Embed 3–4 figures in the README.
- ☒ Add the repository link to your LinkedIn Projects section.
- ☒ Write the Medium version that links back to the GitHub repository.

At that point, your repository will read like a complete applied analytics project rather than just a collection of files.